

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 INTRODUCTION: Consumer attitude means the feelings, beliefs, and opinions that customers have towards a product, service, brand or a company. It shows how customers think and feel while buying or using a product. Customer attitude is formed through personal experience, advertising, word of mouth, price, quality and after sale service. A positive customer attitude leads to satisfaction, loyalty and repeat purchases, while negative customer attitude may result in dissatisfaction and loss of customers. Therefore, understanding customer attitude is very important for business to improve their products, service and overall customer relationship.

An electric vehicles (EV) are a modern means of transport that uses electricity as its main source of power instead of petrol or diesel. It runs with a help of a electric motor or a rechargeable battery. Electric vehicles are considered as eco friendly because they do not produce harmful gasses or make a noise pollution

Electric vehicles (EV) are gaining significant importance in the modern automobile industry due to increasing environmental pollution, rapid depletion of fossil fuels, and rising fuel prices. An electric vehicles uses electricity as its main sources of power and operates with the help of an electric motor and rechargeable battery. Government across the world, including India, are promoting electric vehicles through subsidies, tax benefits and infrastructure development.

Understanding customer attitude towards electric vehicles is essential for manufacturers and policymakers to ensure successful adoption and long term growth of electric vehicles.

1.2 OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY:

- To study the customer satisfaction towards Electric vehicles in rural areas.
 - To study the level of awareness about the Electric vehicles in rural areas.
 - To analyze the perception of customers regarding benefits of Electric vehicles.
 - To identify the factors influencing purchase decision of Electric vehicles in rural areas
 - To examine the challenges and concerns faced by rural customers.
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1.3 LITERATURE REVIEW:

Nagesh et al. (2024) explained that customer attitudes toward electric vehicles are influenced by factors such as environmental awareness, cost, technology acceptance, and availability of charging infrastructure. Their study suggests that lack of awareness and perceived risks can negatively affect attitudes, especially in rural areas where exposure to EV technology is limited.

Tomkins et al. (2025) focused specifically on rural consumers and found that attitudes toward electric vehicles are generally less favourable due to concerns about driving range, charging facilities, and misinformation about EV performance. The study highlights that inadequate infrastructure and limited knowledge are major barriers shaping rural customers' attitudes toward EV adoption.

1.4 RESEARCH METHODOLOGY:

This study uses a descriptive research design to understand customer attitude toward electric vehicles in rural areas. The research is quantitative in nature and is based on data collected from rural customers.

Primary data is collected through questionnaires and surveys, while secondary data is collected from journals, reports, and websites related to electric vehicles. The study uses a sampling method such as convenience or random sampling, selecting rural residents as respondents.

The collected data is analysed using percentage analysis, charts, and statistical tools like MS Excel. The study helps to identify awareness, perception, and willingness of rural customers to adopt electric vehicles.

1.5 SAMPLING METHOD:

- Sample size: 100
- Sample area: Sringeri
- Sampling method: simple random sampling
- Data analysing tool: The data has been analysed through percentage analysis
- Data representation tool: during the study tables, chart, diagrammatical representation were made for data representation

1.6 SCOPE OF THE STUDY:

- The study focuses on selected rural areas/villages to understand the mindset of rural customers regarding electric vehicles
- It examines how far rural people are aware of Electric vehicles, their features, benefits, and government incentives.

- The research analyses opinions, beliefs, and feelings of rural customers towards adopting Electric vehicles
- The study includes factors such as price and affordability, fuel cost savings, environmental concerns, and maintenance cost.
- Based on the study, it may relate attitude with income level, education, and occupation.

1.7 LIMITATIONS OF THE STUDY:

- Many rural customers may not have enough knowledge about EVs, which can affect the accuracy of their opinions.
- Due to time and accessibility issues, the study may cover only a few villages or respondents, so results may not represent all rural areas.
- Some respondents may give socially acceptable answers or guess instead of sharing true views.
- Most rural customers may not have used EVs personally, so attitudes are based on assumptions, not real experience.
- Short duration of the study may limit deep analysis.

2 INDUSTRIAL PROFILE AND COMPANY PROFILE

2.1 INTRODUCTION

India's electric vehicle (EV) sector is experiencing rapid growth, fuelled by government incentives, rising environmental concerns, and technological advancements. With initiatives like the Faster Adoption and Manufacturing of Hybrid and Electric Vehicles (FAME) scheme, India aims to significantly increase EV adoption, revolutionizing its transportation landscape towards sustainability and innovation. The country has set an ambitious target to elevate EV sales to 30% of private cars, 70% of commercial vehicles, 40% of buses, and 80% of two- and three-wheelers by 2030, translating to approximately 80 million EVs on Indian roads, alongside a focus on complete domestic EV production through the 'Make in India' initiative.

Globally, the electric vehicle market was valued at US\$ 755 billion in 2024 and is forecasted to reach US\$ 4,360 billion by 2033, growing at a CAGR of 21.5% from 2025-33. The Indian EV market, valued at US\$ 2.36 billion in 2024, is projected to grow to US\$ 164.42 billion by 2033, registering a remarkable CAGR of 57.23%, while the Indian EV battery market is expected to expand from US\$ 2.22 billion in 2024 to US\$ 13.89 billion



by 2033 at a CAGR of 22.6%. As of Q2 FY26, India's EV sales reached 5,80,664 units, representing 9.98% penetration of total automotive sales with 2W and 3W making up nearly 90% of EV volumes, e-goods carriers posting the highest YoY growth of

158.92%, and EV penetration rising across 2W, 3W passenger and 4W segments QoQ. In October 2025, electric car sales surged to 17,783 units, 56% jump from 11,444 units a year ago and a 9% MoM growth. The overall passenger vehicle market saw record dispatches of over 5,00,000 units in October 2025.

On the infrastructure side, India's public EV charging network is expanding rapidly. As of February 2024, there were 12,146 operational charging stations nationwide, with Maharashtra leading, followed by Delhi and other states. A Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) report highlighted the need for at least 1.32 million charging stations by 2030 to support EV growth, requiring over 4,00,000 installations annually. Major industry players are actively enhancing charging infrastructure, with Hyundai Motor India expanding its ultra-fast network with 11 new stations in key cities such as Mumbai, Pune, Ahmedabad, Hyderabad, Gurugram, and Bangalore, as well as along major highways. State-specific targets complement national efforts: Maharashtra aims for 10% EV share in all new vehicle registrations by December 2025, while Karnataka plans to electrify 100% of its three- and four-wheeler cargo vehicles by December 2030.